about Rs 80,000 crore in the three years as disinvestment capital receipts (excluding the COVID-19 impacted 2020–21). With better management, the ISWF would be expected to earn more dividends for the government, which will get routed through the fund instead of coming from CPSEs. The objective of generating disinvestment revenues can be served by either selling a part of the stake in ISWF or by privatizing companies in the portfolio of ISWF/SMAC and receiving the proceeds as special dividends. Assuming the Fund could create a valuation even equal to the value of equities transferred to it, by selling a 5 per cent stake, the government can generate more than Rs 1.5–2 lakh crore every year as disinvestment resources.

The government must aim at privatizing all commercial CPSEs by 2030, barring a few (ten to fifteen) that can perform as market leaders, managed by a professionally run SWF, and create value generating total returns of not less than 15 per cent a year. India should be free of public-sector undertakings both at the Central and state level.